

SCHOOLS OF VEDANTA (VEDĀNTA)

THREE VEDANTA ARCHITECTURES → ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND → WORLD, ILLUSION AND IGNORANCE → SUPERIMPOSITION AND GREAT STATEMENT → QUALIFIED NON-DUALISM → DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW

SUBORDINATE EXTRA

APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00THREE VEDANTA ARCHITECTURES

THREE VEDANTA ARCHITECTURESONE UPANISHADIC CORPUSTHREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURESNON-DUAL ULTIMATE REALITY; DIFFERENCE BELONGS TO IGNORANCEQUALIFIED UNITY; SELVES AND WORLD ARE REAL MODESGOD, SELVES AND WORLD ARE ETERNALLY DIFFERENT REALITIES ANSWER

COMPARE ONTOLOGY, CAUSATION AND LIBERATION ON THE SAME AXES

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance	Visistadvaita: qualified unity; selves and world are real modes Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities answer control: compare ontology, causation and liberation on the same axes	ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE - ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES - Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance	DECISIVE DISTINCTION - Visistadvaita: qualified unity; selves and world are real modes - Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities answer control: compare ontology, causation and liberation on the same axes	EVALUATION / TRAP - ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES - Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities answer control: compare ontology, causation and liberation on the same axes.

01

STAGE 01ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND SELF

ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND SELFULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN)LORD (ĪŚVARA)TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)QUALITYLESS ULTIMATE REALITY; EMPIRICAL LORD UNDER ILLUSIONPERSONAL QUALIFIED ULTIMATE REALITY WITH INSEPARABLE MODES

INDEPENDENT LORD AND PERMANENTLY DEPENDENT SELVES TRAPTHE THREE SCHOOLS DO NOT USE THE SAME WORD

ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)

Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion

Visistadvaita → personal qualified ultimate reality with inseparable modes

Dvaita → independent Lord and permanently dependent selves trap; the three schools do not use

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN) - Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion	- Visistadvaita → personal qualified ultimate reality with inseparable modes - Dvaita → independent Lord and permanently dependent selves trap: the three schools do not use the same word with the same ontology	- ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN) - Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the three schools do not use the same word with the same ontology.

02

STAGE 02WORLD, ILLUSION AND IGNORANCE

WORLD, ILLUSION AND IGNORANCEAPPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) EMPIRICAL WORLD IS NEITHER ABSOLUTELY REALVISISTADVAITA AND DVAITA AFFIRM A GENUINELY REAL WORLDRAMANUJA'S SEVEN OBJECTIONS TEST LOCUS, NATURE, PROOF, REMOVAL AND

ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) empirical world is neither absolutely real nor sheer non-being indescribable illusion

Ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies

Visistadvaita and Dvaita affirm a genuinely real world

Ramanuja's seven objections test locus, nature, proof, removal and cessation

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) empirical world is neither absolutely real nor sheer non-being indescribable illusion (māyā) projects - Ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies	- Visistadvaita and Dvaita affirm a genuinely real world - Ramanuja's seven objections test locus, nature, proof, removal and cessation	- ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) empirical world is neither absolutely real nor sheer non-being indescribable illusion (māyā) projects - Ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ramanuja's seven objections test locus, nature, proof, removal and cessation.

03

STAGE 03SUPERIMPOSITION AND GREAT STATEMENT

SUPERIMPOSITION AND GREAT STATEMENTSUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA)SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSIONBONDAGE GREAT STATEMENT 'THAT THOU ART' REQUIRES DISCARDING INCOMPATIBLEIF IGNORANCE IS INDEFINABLE, ITS LOCUS AND REMOVAL REMAIN

SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible

It does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory - It does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested	- SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory - It does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested	- SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory - It does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYĀSA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes indescribable-error theory explains rope-snake without making error unreal knowledge removes ignorance; it does not produce the already-real self pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested.

04

STAGE 04QUALIFIED NON-DUALISM

QUALIFIED NON-DUALISMINSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) SELVES AND WORLD ARE REAL BUTTHE WHOLE CONTROLS AND SUPPORTS ITS REAL MODES LIBERATIONUNITY WITHOUT ILLUSIONISM; LIMITPLURALITY MAY QUALIFY ABSOLUTENESS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality body-soul relation: the

limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality body-soul relation: the

limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality body-soul relation: the

limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (APRTHAKSIDDHI) selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality body-soul relation: the whole controls and supports its real modes liberation preserves individuality, devotion and service strength: unity without illusionism; limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness.

05

STAGE 05DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE

DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCEFIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAÑCAVIDHA-BHEDA)WORLD-WORLD DIFFERENCE IS REAL, ETERNAL AND CONSTITUTIVE RATHER THANROBUST REALISM; LIMITPERMANENT HIERARCHY AND PLURALISM NEED DEFENCE

world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful

limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAÑCAVIDHA-BHEDA) - world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful service strength: robust	- limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence - FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAÑCAVIDHA-BHEDA)	- world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful service strength: robust - limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God-self | God-world | self-self | self-world | world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful service strength: robust realism; limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence.

06

STAGE 06LIBERATION AND MAJOR CRITIQUES

LIBERATION AND MAJOR CRITIQUESLIBERATION WHILE LIVING; IDENTITY DISCLOSED BY KNOWLEDGECOMMUNION THROUGH DEVOTION AND GRACEETERNAL DIFFERENCE AND GRADED BLISS COMPARE SHANKARA, RAMANUJA AND

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
- ADVAITA → LIBERATION WHILE LIVING; IDENTITY DISCLOSED BY KNOWLEDGE - Visistadvaita → communion through devotion and grace	- Dvaita → eternal difference and graded bliss compare Shankara, Ramanuja and Madhva through world-status and selfhood never collapse - liberation into one generic Vedantic position	- ADVAITA → LIBERATION WHILE LIVING; IDENTITY DISCLOSED BY KNOWLEDGE - Visistadvaita → communion through devotion and grace

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dvaita → eternal difference and graded bliss compare Shankara, Ramanuja and Madhva through world-status and selfhood never collapse liberation into one generic Vedantic position.

07

STAGE 07PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESISDEFINE COMMON QUESTIONBUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRASTTEST OBJECTIONS ULTIMATE REALITYLIBERATION USE ONE PRECISE DOCTRINE AND ONE RIVAL CRITICISMUINITY, QUALIFIED UNITY AND DIFFERENCE SOLVE DIFFERENT PRESSURES

DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self →

liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what

and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self → world → ignorance/error - liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what each theory preserves	- and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures - DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self → world → ignorance/error	- liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what each theory preserves - and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures.

E

EXTRASUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTOPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — THE VEDANTA MAPULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN), CAUSATION AND ADVAITA MEANS OF VALIDOPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — LORD (ĪŚVARA), TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)ORIGINAL, REFLECTION, MODE OR DEPENDENT SELF

OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — WORLD (JAGAT) AND CAUSATIONAPPEARANCE, DIVINE BODY OR REAL DEPENDENT WORLDOPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — INDESCRIBABLE ILLUSION (MĀYĀ), IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ)

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS	ADVANCED OBJECTION	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — The Vedanta Map: Ultimate reality (brahman), Causation and Advaita Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) - OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — Lord (Īśvara), True self (ātman) and Individual self (jīva): Original, Reflection, Mode or Dependent Self - OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — World (jagat) and Causation: Appearance, Divine Body or Real Dependent World - OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — Indescribable illusion (māyā), Ignorance (avidyā) and Superimposition (adhyāsa): How Advaita Explains Bondage	- OPTIONAL DEPTH 5 — Liberation (mokṣa) Across Vedanta: Recognition, Communion, Service and Grace - OPTIONAL DEPTH 6 — Ramanuja's Qualified Non-Dualism: Inseparable dependence (aprthaksiddhi) and the Body-Soul Model - OPTIONAL DEPTH 7 — Madhva and Wider Vedanta: Five Differences, Nimbarka, Vallabha and Caitanya - OPTIONAL DEPTH 8 — Great Upanishadic statement (mahāvākya) and Error: Tat Tvam Asi, Superimposition (adhyasa) and Indescribable-error theory	(anirvacaniya-khyāti) - OPTIONAL DEPTH 9 — Absolutism, Inter-school Debates and the Critique of Vedanta - OPTIONAL DEPTH 10 — PYQ Routing, Presupposition Ledgers and Answer Architecture - The Taittiriya and Chandogya teaching of an ultimate source is therefore read through vivarta : Ultimate reality (brahman)

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.